PROJECT 10073 RECORD CARD

1. DATE
9-10 Mar 58

2. LOCATION
Panama Canal Zone

3. DATE-TIME GROUP
Local ____
GMT ____

4. TYPE OF OBSERVATION
☐ Ground-Visual ☒ Ground-Radar
☐ Air-Visual ☒ Air-Intercept Radar

5. PHOTOS
☐ Yes
☒ No

6. SOURCE
Military & Civilian

7. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION

8. NUMBER OF OBJECTS
2

9. COURSE

12. CONCLUSIONS
☐ Was Balloon
☐ Probably Balloon
☒ Possibly Balloon
☐ Was Aircraft
☐ Probably Aircraft
☐ Possibly Aircraft
☐ Was Astronomical
☐ Probably Astronomical
☐ Possibly ~~Astronomical~~ FALSE TARGET
☒ Other ~~[illegible]~~
☐ Insufficient Data for Evaluation
☐ Unknown

10. BRIEF SUMMARY OF SIGHTING
1) Two radar tracks generally triangular w/speed varying fm hovering to 1000 Mi per hr. Movement at times appeared evasive. Personnel rptd seeing red & green lights for very short time. A/C sent to investigate w/negative results 2) Obj on radar about 3 times size of freighter & oblong in shape. At 50 miles range the return was exactly the same as a strong cumulus cloud & had a definite cell. At 20 mile range the return dissipated & altho visibility was excellent nothing was sighted.

11. COMMENTS It appears that anamalous propogation is a strong possibility. The fact that the target was not visible at 20 mi w/excellent visibility seems to preclude the targets as material. The first of these sightings seems to indicate the possibility of one or more balloons since the targets were more or less stationary except for alt change. Second sighting seems to indicate a false target because of the erratic nature of the signal return. ~~[illegible]~~

ATIC FORM 329 (REV 26 SEP 52)

[redacted]

UNCLASSIFIED

SUBJECT: Request for Analysis, Radar UFO

TO: AFCIN-4E4 FROM: AFCIN-4E1 DATE: 30 Oct 58 [illegible] COMMENT NR. 2
AFCIN-4E1a/W. Picklesimer/jc
74201/Bldg 828/Rm 241

1. The first of these reported sightings seems to indicate the possibility of one or more balloons since the targets were more or less stationary except for altitude changes. The radar could have broken lock on a balloon at relatively low altitude and then locked on another at higher altitude which would have given the impression that a rapid ascent of the target had occurred. Efforts to sight the target visually failed which would indicate either a small target such as a balloon or possibly a false target. The false target explanation is considered a very small possibility since a second radar reportedly locked on the same target.

2. The second of these reported sightings seems to indicate a false target because of the erratic nature of the signal return and efforts to sight the target visually failed during daylight hours. False radar targets occur occasionally, due mainly to atmospheric and weather phenomena, but sometimes due to spurious signals from various sources of interference.

for R L James
GORDON C. HOFFMAN
Colonel, USAF
AFCIN-4E1

3 Incls
n/c

If inclosure #1 is withdrawn (or not attached), the classification of this correspondence will be downgraded to Uncl in accordance with paragraph 37b AFR205-1.

Classification Cancelled
Auth. [illegible]
By [illegible]
Date 1 8 MAY [illegible]
AFR 205-1, Par 27a
3 Jan 68

[illegible] INTERVALS:
[illegible] YEARS
[illegible]

UNCLASSIFIED

[redacted]

AF FORM 112
APPROVED 1 JUNE 1948

[redacted]
(CLASSIFICATION)
UNCLASSIFIED

1/2 · 484-23

COUNTRY PANAMA	REPORT IR-4-58	(LEAVE BLANK)

AIR INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

SUBJECT Unidentified Flying Object Report	
AREA REPORTED ON PANAMA	FROM (Agency) Director of Intelligence - CAirC
DATE OF REPORT 18 March 1958 APR 21 1958	DATE OF INFORMATION 9-10 March 1958
	EVALUATION B-1
PREPARED BY (Officer) Vernon D. Adams, Capt., USAF	SOURCE Caribbean Command AOC
REFERENCES (Control number, directive, previous report, etc., as applicable) AFR 200-2	

SUMMARY: (Enter concise summary of report. Give significance in final one-sentence paragraph. List inclosures at lower left. Begin text of report on AF Form 112 - Part II)

A number of unidentified radar tracks were observed 9-10 March 1958 by search and tracking radar located in the Canal Zone. Two tracks were investigated by aircraft with negative results.

Vernon D. Adams
VERNON D. ADAMS
Capt., USAF
Ass't. Director of Intelligence

APPROVED BY:

George Welter
GEORGE WELTER
Lt Col., USAF
Director of Intelligence

Classification Cancelled
Auth. ~~[illegible]~~ DP
By ~~[illegible]~~
Date ~~13 MAY 1969~~
AFR 205-1, par 2-17c
3 Jan 68

[illegible]

4 INCLS.

WAC #769 (Uncl)
~~G-2 USARCARIB Report~~ (Conf)
~~Log of M & I Section (Uncl)~~
Track Reports (Uncl)

1137

THIS DOCUMENT CONTAINS INFORMATION AFFECTING THE NATIONAL DEFENSE OF THE UNITED STATES WITHIN THE MEANING OF THE ESPIONAGE ACT, 50 U.S.C. 31 AND 32, AS AMENDED. ITS TRANSMISSION OR THE REVELATION OF ITS CONTENTS IN ANY MANNER TO AN UNAUTHORIZED PERSON IS PROHIBITED BY LAW. IT MAY NOT BE REPRODUCED IN WHOLE OR IN PART, BY OTHER THAN UNITED STATES AIR FORCE AGENCIES, EXCEPT BY PERMISSION OF THE DIRECTOR OF INTELLIGENCE, USAF.

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SUPPLEMENT TO AF FORM 112

ORIGINATING AGENCY	REPORT NO.	PAGE 2 OF 7 PAGES
CAirC - Dir. of Intelligence	IR-4-53	

During the period 9 through 13 March, three unexplainable radar contacts have been made by equipment located in the Canal Zone. On two occasions, aircraft were vectored into the area by the radar sites, with negative results. Interrogation of scope operators has indicated that returns were strong and easily distinguished from cloud formations. Returns were definite when associated with clouds. Generally the tracks were triangular with speed of movement very erratic. Movement appears at times to be evasive action. The incident of 9 - 10 March was tracked by gun laying radar. During period of observation, radar maintenance personnel checked out their system thoroughly. In addition, lock was broken, however, the equipment immediately picked up target and locked on. A second tracking radar situated on Taboga, Island, locked on the return. Target generally remained in same area half way between radar sites. Personnel stationed at sites reported seeing red and green lights but no noise was associated with lights Visibility was good. However, lights were visible for only a short period. A commercial flight volunteered to investigate target. He was vectored within a hundred yards of target and reported negative sighting. Target faded out at 0208R on 10 March.

At 10:12R on 10 March, search radar reported unidentified target west of canal. A T-33 from Howard Field was sent to investigate. Negative results. Aircraft was in the immediate area of target with negative sighting. Contact with target was broken at 14:15R.

VERNON D. ADAMS
Captain, USAF
Ass't. Director of Intelligence

APPROVED BY:

George Welter
GEORGE WELTER
Lt Col., USAF
Director of Intelligence

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SUPPLEMENT TO AF FORM 112

ORIGINATING AGENCY AC OF S, G-2 USARCARIB	REPORT NO. IR-4-58	PAGE 3 OF 7 PAGES

In accordance with Department of the Army Intelligence Collection Memorandum #200-72B-1, dated 6 August 1957, subject: "Unconventional Aircraft", the following information is submitted:

1. On 10 March 1958, Capt. Harold E. Stahlman, Operations Officer, 764th Anti-Aircraft Operations Center (AAOC), Fort Clayton Canal Zone, reported information concerning the sighting of an unidentified flying object. At 2003R, 9 March 1958, Stahlman, as Deputy Defense Commander for Anti-Aircraft Defenses, was notified at his home by the Operations Duty Officer, AAOC, that the AAOC had received a radar report of an unidentified aircraft approaching the Pacific side of the Isthmus of Panama. Stahlman arrived at the AAOC at approximately 2008R.

During the radar tracking of the first blip which appeared on the radar screen, two additional blips were observed at 2045R. The first echo was identified as a Chilean Airlines aircraft which landed at Tocumen Airport, Tocumen, Republic of Panama. The two other blips, which were not identified, indicated that the two objects were in the vicinity of Fort Kobbe, Canal Zone. A civilian aircraft in the general vicinity of the objects made a visual search of the area with negative results. The original blips were picked up by Search Radar and then transferred to the Track Radar Unit located at Flamenco Island, Fort Amador, Canal Zone. This unit was able to lock on the unidentified objects and the following information was obtained:

Number of Objects:	Two, approximately one hundred yards apart.
Duration of Radar Observation:	2003R, 9 March 1958, to 0208R, 10 March 1958.
Location of Radar:	Battery D, 764th AAA Bn, Flamenco Island
Location of Object:	LJ 2853. (Geo-Ref, Military Grid Reference System)
Prevailing Weather:	Clear, visibility unlimited no wind reported.
Direction of Flight:	Average angle of elevation, 365°, Azimuth, 330 mils.
Manner of Flight:	Steady, slight circular path over the vicinity of Fort Kobbe, Canal Zone.
Altitude:	Varied from two to ten thousand feet. Average of seven thousand feet.

An attempt was made by members of the Radar Site, Flamenco Island, to observe the objects by searchlights. When the light touched the objects, they traveled from an altitude of two thousand feet to ten thousand feet in five to ten seconds.

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SUPPLEMENT TO AF FORM 112

ORIGINATING AGENCY	REPORT NO.	
CAirC, Director of Intel.	IR-4-58	PAGE 2 6 OF 3 7 PAGES

EXTRACTS FROM THE LOG AT MOVEMENT & IDENTIFICATION SECTION ADCC

09 March

19:59 Unknown aircraft flying Tango Route inbound. No known aircraft in area but one advised by Tocumen, WHZ BLB ATC.

20:45 Unidentified blip believed to be weather balloon picked up between Albrook and Taboga. Appears to be orbiting. No air traffic in area at all. Advised ATC of possibility of object interfering with air traffic.

20:45 Advised that a balloon had been released earlier in the evening at approximately 1830R but should be down southeast of Albrook at present time.

21:40 Tower advised P-501 (Pan American Flight) is cleared by Albrook ATC for DF instructions in order to avoid object. Flight P501 will cross the canal over Albrook.

23:45 Distance of object from D Battery (Flamingo) is 4870 yards, height 3.5 thousand feet. At the present time, a searchlight from harbor entrance control point is being used to aid in identification purposes, to be executed by one AF-Naval crash boat.

23:55 Object now at 6.0 feet moving away very rapidly to the southwest.

24:00 Radar advises that as soon as searchlight was employed, the object became evasive. Object now at 10.0 feet, 7800 yards from site. Two returns, one at 10.0 feet, other at 08.

10 March

00:44 Braniff Flight 400 reports negative sighting of object during brief investigation. Radar reported aircraft was approximately 100 yards from object.

00:55 Radar reports two targets now approximately 100 yards apart. Braniff Flight 400 landed at 0047.

02:10 Radar contact lost.

10:12 Unknown aircraft at KJ1646, speed 290K. No known aircraft in area. Check with Tocumen, Albrook, Howard, ATC & CAA. Blip very practical, has reached speed of 900K then slows to a complete stop for several minutes before moving again.

10:30 Major Davis at Howard Operations advised of UFO. He will go up and take a look.

11:20 AF 5289 (T-33) airborne to check UFO. UFO was observed

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DOW[illegible]RVALS;
DECL[illegible] YEARS.
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